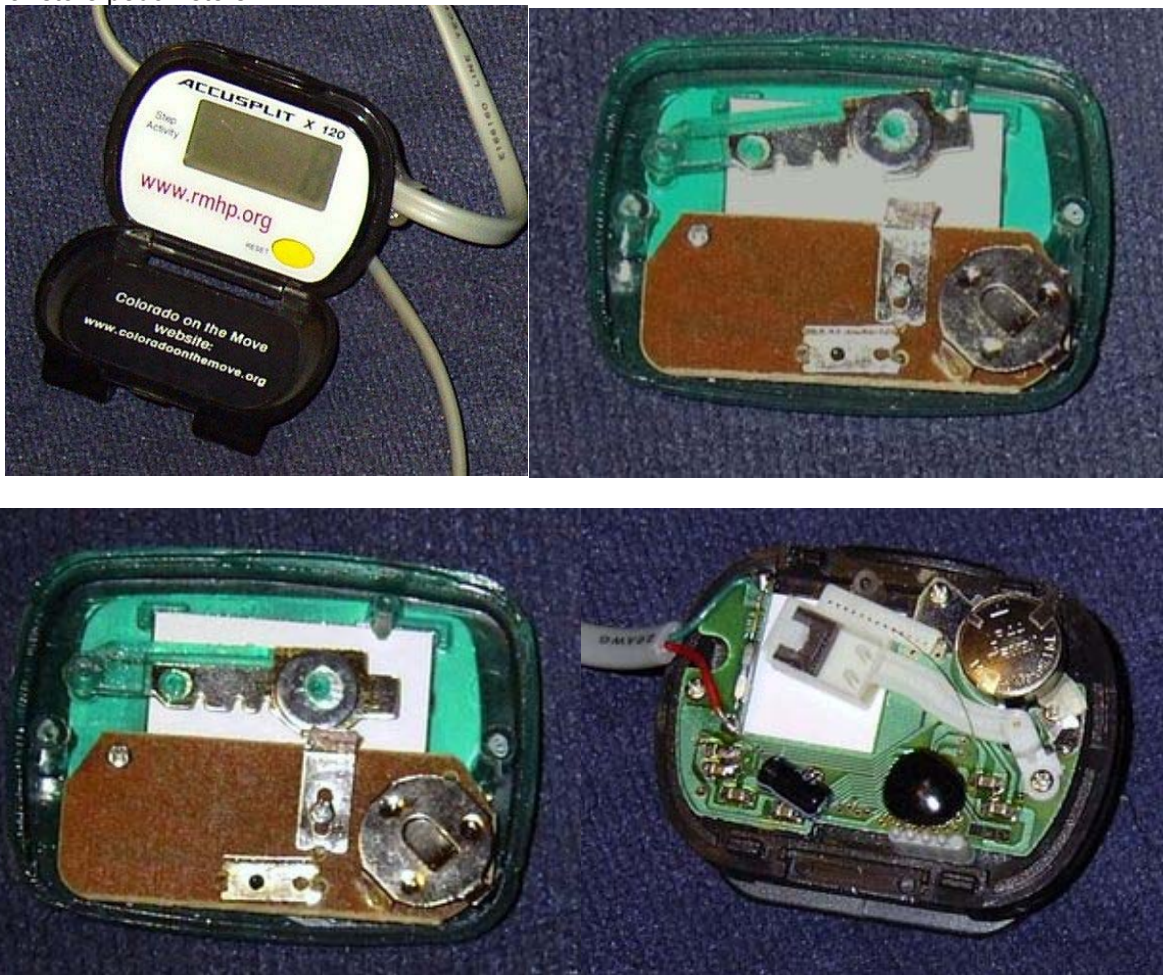


Pedometer Teardown

Dollar store pedometers



Most cheap pedometers use the same basic design. A little weighted arm is held up by a tiny spring. When the user walks, the hip movement and gravity lets the arm drop down closing an electrical contact. When opening up the pedometer, be very careful as there usually is a tiny spring that can come off and get lost. That's what happened to this one. On this one, the spring went from the bottom metal plate to the metal arm. The spring was part of the electrical circuit that connected the bottom plate to the arm. When the user steps, gravity forces the metal arm down so that it touches the upper metal plate and electrically shorts the two metal plates together.

Procedure:

Take the cover off the pedometer. It may use screws or mine opened with a twist of a coin.

- Carefully turn on the pedometer.
- Check electrical function with digital multimeter set to VDC.
- Place the black-negative lead on the bottom metal plate, place the red-positive lead on the upper metal plate.
- Measure the voltage, it will probably read about 1.2 VDC
- If you want and are dexterous, while holding the probes on the pedometer, move the arm down so that it touching the top plate. The voltage should read 0 VDC.